WEDNESDAY, OCTOBER 21, 2026 VOL. I · NO. 143 193 STORIES · 18 SOURCES

THE BITSTREAM

AN IT & TECHNOLOGY DAILY — AUTOMATICALLY COMPILED

LEAD STORY · CYBERSECURITY

PHP2Shell: Two Unpatched Critical PHP RCE Flaws (CVSS 9.2) Trigger Emergency Security Alert

THIS STORY IS DEVELOPING and was written before PHP's scheduled 14:00 UTC release on October 21. Once the release is out, the affected and fixed versions below are confirmed by the official advisory. PHP will ship an out-of-cycle security release at 14:00 UTC today, October 21, for two critical vulnerabilities that...

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AI

OpenAI's agents disabled their own safety monitoring systems

OpenAI reveals that its agents misbehaved by switching off the system monitoring them for misbehaviors.

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CYBERSECURITY

Microsoft says October updates didn’t actually fix VPN issues

Microsoft says it mistakenly flagged a bug causing Always On VPN connection issues as fixed in the October 2026 Windows 11 cumulative updates. [...]

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Score a 1440p-ready gaming PC with an RTX 5060 Ti 16GB for under $1,500 right now, saving you $200

You can pick up this ABS Cyclone Aqua gaming PC with an RTX 5060 Ti 16GB, Intel Core i7-14700F, 16GB DDR5, and a 1TB SS with a $200 discount, now $1,499.99.

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SOFTWARE

Java crashes the departure board at Tyne and Wear Metro

Train times remain on show as an elderly Windows dialog demands attention

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AI & MACHINE LEARNING

05 stories

AI

OpenAI's agents disabled their own safety monitoring systems

OpenAI reveals that its agents misbehaved by switching off the system monitoring them for misbehaviors.

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AI

HPE says it will run the first supercomputer benchmarks on the Moon

HPE’s Spaceborne Computer-4 will ride Astrolab’s FLIP rover to the Moon’s south pole to run HPL, HPCG, and AI tests.

TOM'S HARDWARE · JUST NOW

AI

Stop choosing the wrong Agentic AI use cases

Why businesses must rethink agentic AI before scaling costly, ineffective use cases.

TECHRADAR · JUST NOW

AI

Foldable phones could be hot – in more ways than one

Foldable phones expose the thermal limits of edge AI and the need for new cooling solutions.

TECHRADAR · JUST NOW

AI

Google SynthID Detector Simplifies Watermark Detection and Expands Support to Other AI Providers

Google DeepMind announced the global availability of SynthID Detector, a tool designed to help identify AI-generated content, including media created using AI tools from SynthID partners such as OpenAI, NVIDIA, and Kakao, with Apple support expected soon. By Sergio De Simone

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CYBERSECURITY

04 stories

CYBERSECURITY

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CYBERSECURITY

Attackers Abuse UpdraftCentral Keys to Plant Backdoors on WordPress Sites

Unknown threat actors breached TeamUpdraft's website and potentially gained unauthorized access to customers' connection keys for UpdraftCentral, UpdraftVault, and UpdraftClone, using them to backdoor WordPress sites. TeamUpdraft is the developer behind UpdraftPlus, a popular WordPress backup plugin with over four…

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CYBERSECURITY

CISA: SafePay ransomware hit over 600 critical infrastructure orgs

The Cybersecurity and Infrastructure Security Agency (CISA) says the SafePay ransomware gang has breached over 600 critical infrastructure organizations worldwide since 2024. [...]

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CYBERSECURITY

U.S. Orders DeepSeek Removed From Federal Civilian Systems, Bans New Purchases

U.S. federal civilian agencies must remove DeepSeek products from their information technology systems, along with any third-party products or services "developed using DeepSeek implementations," under a Department of Homeland Security order. They may also no longer buy information technology products or services from…

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HARDWARE & CHIPS

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HARDWARE

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HARDWARE

Three workers killed, one in intensive care after fall at TSMC’s 2nm fab construction site

Three contract workers died, and one is in intensive care after a fall at TSMC’s Fab 22 construction site in Kaohsiung, Taiwan.

TOM'S HARDWARE · 1H AGO

HARDWARE

Jensen Huang Nvidia GTC keynote disrupted by Greenpeace protest over chips in Russian drones

Jensen Huang's Nvidia GTC keynote speech in Berlin was disrupted by a Greenpeace protest on Wednesday.

TOM'S HARDWARE · 1H AGO

HARDWARE

TornadoVM 7 Enables GPU-Native Workloads From Java Applications

TornadoVM, an open-source heterogeneous programming framework for Java has reached version 7.0. It automatically accelerates Java programs on multi-core CPUs and GPUs and provides a rich GPU programming ecosystem in Java that can be used with any mainstream JDK distribution e.g. Temurin, Red Hat OpenJDK, Coretto…

INFOQ · 8H AGO

HARDWARE

Minisforum’s Thunderbolt 5 dock lets mini PCs run a full desktop GPU for video editing

Minisforum’s DEG2 dock lets you run a full-size desktop graphics card over Thunderbolt 5 or OCuLink, which gives video editors much faster effects and exports.

TECHRADAR · 14H AGO

SOFTWARE & DEV

05 stories

SOFTWARE

Java crashes the departure board at Tyne and Wear Metro

Train times remain on show as an elderly Windows dialog demands attention

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SOFTWARE

The spec is the new code, so brush up on your prose, says Kaseya CTO

Domain expertise and clear writing will matter more than syntax, and yes, that means documentation

THE REGISTER · 1H AGO

SOFTWARE

Article: Distributed Spring Batch Without a Message Broker

Distributed Spring Batch partitioning already needs a shared, persistent job repository. This article makes that database the whole coordination plane and drops the message broker, sizing work to the live node count, a per-job master with no standing coordinator, compare-and-set claiming that prevents…

INFOQ · 2H AGO

SOFTWARE

Cilium 1.20 Expands Gateway API and Opens eBPF Datapath for Kubernetes

Cilium 1.20 has been released with broader Kubernetes Gateway API support, an extensible eBPF datapath and further work on sidecarless mutual TLS. The release also makes the newer netkit network device easier to introduce across Kubernetes fleets that run different Linux kernel versions. By Matt Saunders

INFOQ · 2H AGO

SOFTWARE

MPs urge UK government to play venture capitalist with taxpayer-funded tech

Watchdog says Whitehall is too timid about taking stakes in British startups, leaving taxpayers at risk of missing out when they strike gold

THE REGISTER · 2H AGO

BUSINESS & BIG TECH

05 stories

BUSINESS

YouTube might be testing hiding the dislike button

YouTube appears to be testing hiding the dislike button on videos, as reported by 9to5Google. At least two users on X have recently shared screenshots of the dislike button now being placed in the three-dots submenu, and a user on Reddit also shared an image of the dislike button being absent for them. Right now, […]

THE VERGE · 11H AGO

BUSINESS

SpaceX and Tesla boards form special committees to review merger

Elon Musk likes the idea but says he is not on either committee, which is made up of independent directors.

TECHCRUNCH · 12H AGO

BUSINESS

Microsoft reportedly projects $1,200 to $1,800 price for 2028 Project Helix

Xbox maker is also apparently planning its own gaming handheld for next year.

ARS TECHNICA · 13H AGO

BUSINESS

Netflix is telling investors not to worry, even though you're watching less and less

Netflix is making monetization a top priority amid reports of falling viewing time. As part of its third-quarter earnings report on Tuesday, Netflix lists improvements to monetization as one of its main focuses going forward, alongside efforts to boost entertainment value and leverage new technology. The streaming…

THE VERGE · 14H AGO

BUSINESS

Snap is paying Robert Downey Jr. to do the Iron Man thing

Snap has a new brand ambassador for its Specs AR glasses: Iron Man actor Robert Downey Jr. The company has brought on Downey as Specs' "Chief Customer Experience Officer" and has published several videos featuring Downey showcasing the capabilities of the new glasses, including as a tool to get help with a putt…

THE VERGE · 14H AGO

GADGETS & CONSUMER

05 stories

GADGETS

Save a massive $850 on Lenovo's Legion 5i gaming laptop with this 32% Best Buy discount

Save $850 on a new Lenovo gaming laptop from Best Buy. Pick up the Legion 5i with RTX 5070 graphics and save 32%.

TOM'S HARDWARE · JUST NOW

GADGETS

When technology becomes part of the talent infrastructure

AI-ready PCs and smarter device strategies improve employee experience, productivity, and retention.

TECHRADAR · JUST NOW

GADGETS

What can you use your Apple Watch Ultra 4 action button for?

Here's what your Apple Watch Ultra 4 action button can really do, from launching workouts and retracing routes to controlling smart home devices with one tap.

ENGADGET · 11H AGO

GADGETS

The dark side of 'free' mobile games — how developers reverse-engineer your patience to milk ad revenue

Block Blast reportedly earned $127 million from ads, but an investigation uncovered code allegedly manipulating difficulty, player profiling, and incentives to watch ads.

TECHRADAR · 11H AGO

GADGETS

The WD Elements 6TB Desktop HDD is the no-fuss backup drive I'd plug into a home PC

Ideal for homes and home offices, the WD Elements 6TB Desktop HDD is a simple plug-and-play backup drive for Windows PC users, with a two-year warranty.

TECHRADAR · 11H AGO

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